

Casan Evans, RHP, LSU

2026 Stats: 5.93 ERA/60.2 IP/1.401 WHIP/89 K/31 BB/2.87 K:BB

6-2, 196

Metrics

FB: 94.6/18.5 IVB/11.6 HB/-4.86 VAA/5.9 ext/6.4 relH/38.1% zone/49 AA/38.6% usage/2460 rpm

SI: 94.1/12.7 IVB/16.3 HB/-6.03 VAA/28.6% zone/38.4 AA/6.4% usage/2410 rpm

CT: 86.7/7.9 IVB/0.9 HB/-6.48 VAA/23.5% zone/40 AA/15.4% usage/2450 rpm

CB: 79.4/-7 IVB/-5.5 HB/-9.47 VAA/37.5% zone/51.4 AA/14.5% usage/2440 rpm

SPL: 82.6/3.5 IVB/12.1 HB/-7.88 VAA/32.5% zone/39.8 AA/25.1% usage/1430 rpm

Write-up

An integral part of LSU's 2025 championship team, Casan Evans is a long-levered right-hander with a power FB/SPL combination that fueled much of his success as a freshman. There might even be some room for muscle as the 6-2/196 frame looks like it could hold a bit more velo going forward. His strike throwing regressed in 2026 after transitioning into a starter's workload, walking 1.4 more batters per nine innings than the year prior. Despite this, Evans continued to miss bats at an elite rate, eclipsing 13 K/9 while facing SEC competition and establishing a strong floor as a future high-leverage reliever.

When Evans reached 2 strikes in 2026, 31% of those pitches resulted in punchouts, reinforcing the need for him to establish the zone feel early so that he can use his secondaries to finish at bats. Overall, the five-pitch arsenal Evans showed in 2026 sets him up as one of the more intriguing bounce-back candidates. The splitter is a big league secondary, while the cutter and curveball flashed enough to suggest a complete starter's mix to accompany a solid FB. He currently projects as a 3-4 starter at the next level, though continued development of the strike-throwing will determine whether he remains in a rotation long term or ultimately settles into a late-inning relief role.

The FB holds plus velo from the right side and tops out at about 98 mph. From a high release point, the pitch is pretty steep through the zone but exhibits real ride and at times plus ASR to accompany the velo through the zone. While the raw traits are impressive, the current shape plays closer to average

than the underlying metrics suggest, and the results backed that up in 2026. The FB only got a 7% SWSTR and was hit to a .315 avg. Evans showed a consistent ability to put the ball on the outer half to both sides but the leaky misses led to damage with a 49% hard hit rate. When he was able to get the FB down and away it performed better than up in the zone, despite whiffs being elevated, so being able to hit that target more consistently before 2K will help limit damage going forward. Further, there could be some upside against LHH in sequencing and a more diversified attack plan that could help shield the FB. 45/50 pitch

The SI was used nearly exclusively to RHH in '26 and was effective at getting into their hands. The movement does not jump out at you on video or metrically, but the ASR and slight depth are valuable against RHH where Evans was able to go ride away-run in as an effective tunnel. The pitch performed well, with an above average zone rate and lots of ground balls (79%) while not allowing an extra base hit. Incorporating more sink to righties and lefties could help protect the FB but the pitch is limited in total upside due to below average shape. 40/45 pitch

The CT is stock depth with below average cut, and often has slight back up. The Tigers (and likely Evans) call the pitch a slider, but shape and results do show cutter traits. It was simply his best pitch on the year allowing a .107, 54% whiff rate, and 42% putaway rate. This was done nearly exclusively to RHH with its usage to lefties being under 5%. The low zone rate deceives as he was exceptional at putting the cutter in pitchers locations. He was consistently down and away to righties where he got 38 total whiffs on the year. Hitters swing a lot at the pitch, laying off less than half the time suggesting good release and tunnel. I think an uptick in LHH usage is in order. 50/55 pitch

The CB was used mostly to lefties this year and was barely swung at showcasing elite strike stealing abilities with a sub 30% swing rate and 41% CSW. The shape is short but he gets late bite from the high release. The whiffs were exclusively down and in to lefties and beneath the zone. Continued improvements burying with 2 strikes can help this pitch get more swing and miss in 27 as it only got a 13.2 SWSTR due to the low swing rate. When batters did swing, it garnered a 46% whiff rate. 50/55 pitch

The SPL is the foundation of the arsenal and his best strike pitch, garnering a strike nearly 70% of the time with an absurd 52% whiff/31.7% SWSTR which amounted to 79 total whiffs on the season. It has both ASR and depth with late downwards bite and he commands it to the bottom half exceptionally. Even when batters made contact, it was on the ground and soft. The pitch sometimes lacks that bite but just as often it gets below the 0-line, finding consistency in the shape will push the pitch into a new realm. 60/70 pitch